Attention Is Not Memory

How context changes interpretation

SCAN / LEARN

THE MAIN IDEA

Attention helps relate parts of the current context. It is not the same as remembering a fact after the conversation ends.

FOLLOW THE SYSTEM

01

THE SENTENCE

"The cat chased the mouse because it..."

02

RELATIONSHIPS

The model compares parts of the sentence.

03

ATTENTION

Different words influence how another word is represented.

04

INTERPRETATION

Context helps the model choose a continuation.

CONTEXT → CONNECTIONS → WEIGHTS → MEANING

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Attention means the model permanently remembers this sentence.

MORE ACCURATE

Attention operates over available context; lasting memory needs a separate mechanism.

THREE QUESTIONS TO KEEP

PROBLEM: Which words matter to interpreting "it"?

FAILURE: Missing context can change the meaning.

IN REAL LIFE: Summarization, translation, document reading.

SOLO DISCOVERY

Try alone: compare "The glass broke because it fell" and "The glass broke because it was fragile."